# Estimation

Size work together quickly with planning poker, T-shirt sizes or affinity estimation, or decide not to estimate.

Iterate · Planning Poker · T-Shirt Sizing · Affinity Estimation · Relative, Not Absolute

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 6 May

## 1 Planning Poker

FOR A HANDFUL OF ITEMS

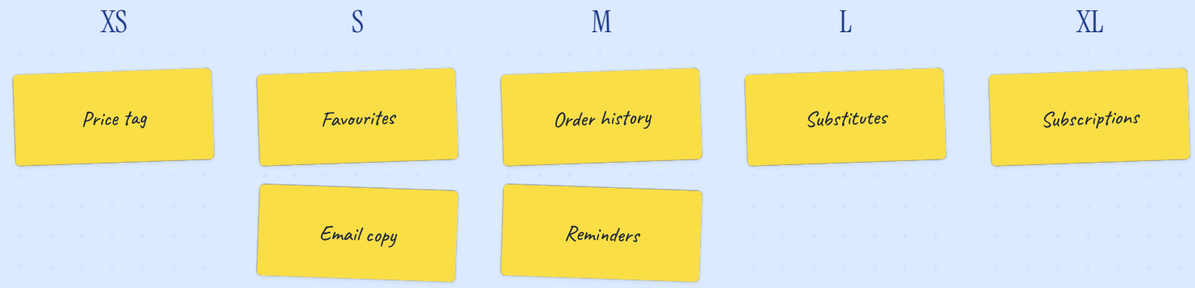
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 13 | 20 | ? | ☕ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

1. Read the item
2. Pick a card privately
3. Reveal together
4. Highest and lowest explain
5. Re-vote, two rounds at most

| ITEM | ROUND 1 | ROUND 2 | ESTIMATE |
|---|---|---|---|
| Reorder from order history | 3, 8, 5, 5 | 5 | 5 |
| Save favourites | 2, 3, 3, 2 | 3 | 3 |
| Suggest substitutes | 5, 13, 8, 8 | 8, 8, 8, 13 | 8 (split it) |

## 2 T-Shirt Sizing

FOR MANY ITEMS, ROUGHLY

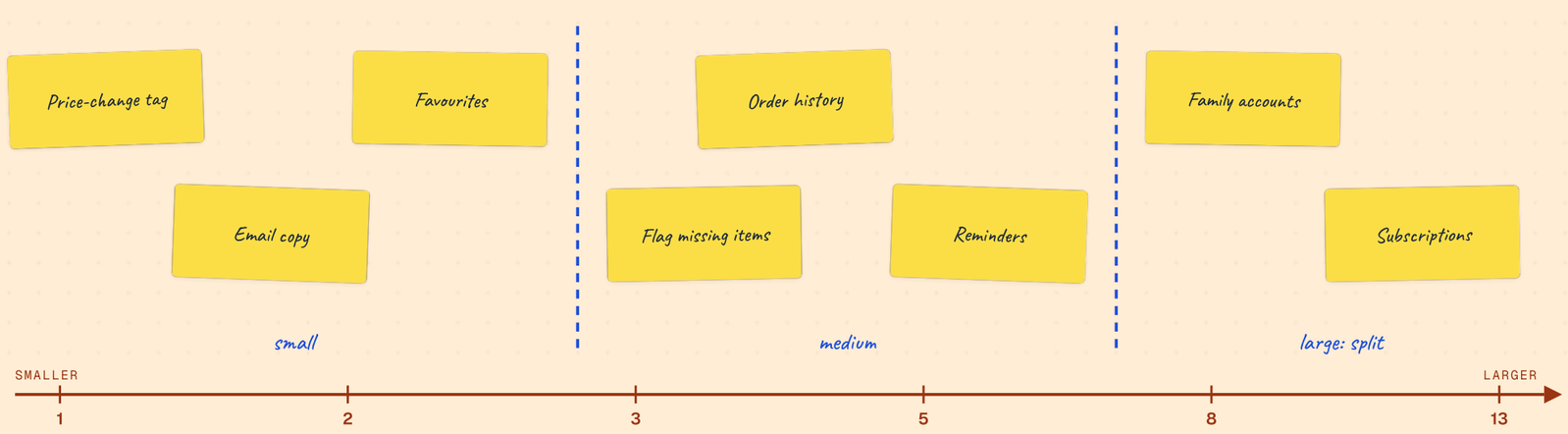



Reference item that is an “M”: reorder events (6 days)

## 3 Affinity Estimation

FOR A WHOLE BACKLOG IN AN HOUR

- Silently place items left to right, smallest to largest. Anyone can move any item.
- Then discuss items that keep moving, and draw size boundaries.




## 4 Reference Items

SHARED EXAMPLES KEEP SIZES CONSISTENT

| SIZE | ITEM EVERYONE REMEMBERS | WHY THIS SIZE |
|---|---|---|
| S | Email confirmation | one screen, no new data |
| M | Reorder events | new data, privacy check |
| L | Order history | three screens, new API |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

## 5 Or Don't Estimate

COUNTING ITEMS OFTEN FORECASTS JUST AS WELL

- If items are split small enough to finish within your SLE, count them instead of sizing them.
- Forecast from throughput with the Release Forecast board.

- [x] We'll try counting items instead of estimating for 2 iterations, then compare

## 6 Ground Rules

- [x] Estimates belong to the people doing the work
- [x] An estimate is a forecast, not a promise
- [x] Never compare points between teams

*“Is this bigger or smaller than the last thing we finished?”*

*“Do we need a number, or do we just need to know it's small?”*

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